



Easy Homemade Canned Pickles Recipe for Crisp, Tangy Flavor All Year

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15 min
PREP



30 min
COOK



45 min
TOTAL



4
SERVINGS



Easy
DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- 6 cups fresh cucumbers, sliced into spears
- 4 cups white vinegar
- 4 cups water
- 1/4 cup kosher salt
- 4 cloves garlic, smashed

- 2 tablespoons mustard seeds
- 2 teaspoons dill seeds
- 4 fresh dill sprigs
- 1 teaspoon black peppercorns

Instructions

1. Start by washing your cucumbers thoroughly to remove any dirt or residue. Slice them into spears about 3 to 4 inches long, making sure they are fairly uniform for even pickling. Place the sliced cucumbers in a large bowl of ice water and let them soak for at least 30 minutes. This soaking step helps to firm up the cucumbers by drawing out excess moisture, which is key to getting that satisfying crunch in the final canned pickles. Avoid skipping this step or using warm water, as it can result in softer pickles. After soaking, drain the cucumbers well and pat them dry with a clean kitchen towel to remove any excess water. ⌚ 40
2. While the cucumbers soak, prepare the pickling brine by combining white vinegar, water, and kosher salt in a large pot. Bring this mixture to a boil over medium-high heat, stirring occasionally to dissolve the salt completely. The vinegar provides the essential acidity to preserve the pickles and develop their tangy flavor, while the salt enhances taste and helps maintain crispness. Boiling the brine ensures the flavors meld and sterilizes the solution for safe canning. Once boiling, reduce the heat to low and keep the brine warm until ready to pour over the cucumbers. Do not rush this step by pouring cold brine over the cucumbers, as it can affect texture and preservation. ⌚ 15
3. Prepare your canning jars by washing them in hot, soapy water and rinsing thoroughly. To sterilize, place the jars in a large pot of boiling water for 10 minutes or run them through a hot dishwasher cycle. Sterilized jars prevent contamination and ensure your pickles stay fresh longer. Keep the jars warm until filling to avoid cracking when hot brine is added. Also, prepare the lids and bands by simmering them in hot water (do not boil) to soften the sealing compound. ⌚ 15
4. Add a couple of garlic cloves, a tablespoon of mustard seeds, a teaspoon of dill seeds, and a few black peppercorns to the bottom of each sterilized jar. These spices infuse the pickles with classic tangy and aromatic flavors. Avoid overfilling the jars with spices, which can overpower the cucumbers. Place a fresh dill sprig on top of the spices in each jar for a bright herbal note. This layering ensures the flavors distribute evenly during the pickling process. ⌚ 5
5. Pack the drained cucumber spears tightly into each jar, standing them upright if possible. Leave about 1/2 inch of headspace at the top to allow for expansion during processing and to ensure a proper seal. Overpacking can cause jars to crack or lids to fail, while underpacking wastes space and brine. Firm but gentle packing keeps the

cucumbers intact and ready for pickling. Wipe the rims of the jars clean with a damp cloth to remove any residue that might interfere with sealing. ⌚ 10

6. Pour the hot brine carefully over the cucumbers in each jar, covering them completely while maintaining the 1/2 inch headspace. The hot brine helps to slightly soften the cucumbers and infuse them with flavor. Tap the jars gently to release any trapped air bubbles, which can cause spoilage if left inside. Use a non-metallic utensil to slide around the inside edges to dislodge bubbles. Wipe the rims again if needed before placing the lids on. ⌚ 10
7. Seal the jars with the sterilized lids and screw on the bands fingertip-tight. Do not over-tighten, as air must escape during processing. Place the jars in a boiling water bath canner, ensuring they are fully submerged by at least 1 inch of water. Process the jars for 10 minutes to create a vacuum seal and preserve the pickles safely. This step kills any bacteria and extends shelf life. After processing, carefully remove the jars and place them on a towel to cool undisturbed for 12 to 24 hours. ⌚ 15
8. Once cooled, check the seals by pressing the center of each lid; it should not flex up or down. Label the jars with the date and store them in a cool, dark place for at least two weeks before opening to allow flavors to develop fully. This resting period is essential for the pickles to absorb the brine and become perfectly tangy and crisp. Refrigerate any jars that do not seal properly and consume within a few weeks. ⌚ 5
9. When ready to enjoy, open a jar and serve your homemade canned pickles chilled or at room temperature. They're fantastic on sandwiches, burgers, or as a crunchy snack. Leftover opened jars should be refrigerated and eaten within a month for best quality. The pickles will maintain their crispness and tangy flavor for several months when stored unopened in a pantry. Enjoy the satisfaction of your homemade canned pickles any time of year! ⌚ 5

Chef Tips

⌚ Soak cucumbers in ice water before canning for maximum crunch.

This step helps firm up the cucumbers by drawing out excess water, which prevents sogginess during pickling. Skipping it often results in soft, limp pickles.

⌚ Use kosher salt instead of table salt for a cleaner flavor and better texture.

Kosher salt lacks additives that can discolor or affect the flavor of pickles. It also dissolves evenly, ensuring consistent salting and crispness.

⚠ Don't over-tighten jar lids before processing to allow air to escape.

Over-tightening prevents air from escaping during boiling, which can cause jars to crack or fail to seal properly, risking spoilage.

Storage & Reheating

❏ Refrigerator

Once opened, store pickles in their brine in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 1 month. The flavor may intensify, and the pickles remain crisp when kept cold.

❏ Freezer

Freezing is not recommended for canned pickles as it can damage texture and cause the brine to become cloudy. Best to consume fresh or properly canned jars.

❏ Reheating

Pickles are best served cold or at room temperature. No reheating is needed. If used in cooked dishes, add towards the end to maintain crunch.

Nutrition (per serving)

15 kcal

CALORIES

0.5g

PROTEIN

3g

CARBS

0g

FAT

1g

FIBER

700mg

SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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